



The AI Banking Institute
Turning Bankers into Builders

QUICK CARD - V2.1

Prompt Strategy Cheat Sheet

A concise reference for safer, more useful AI prompts in banking. Use it to strip sensitive data, give the model enough context, request a reviewable format, and keep a qualified human in the loop.

Use CORE before asking AI to help

Context, Objective, Resources, Expectations. The structure the AiBI-Foundation course teaches. If one part is missing, the output is harder to trust.

PART	PROMPT MOVE	BANKING USE
Context	Say what perspective to use, who it is for, and the business setting.	"You are a branch operations trainer. This is for frontline staff before a Monday huddle."
Objective	Name the exact task, not just the topic.	"Turn the new cash-handling procedure into a checklist."
Resources	Point to the approved source and forbid guessing. Placeholders only.	"Use only the procedure text below."
Expectations	Set the output shape, the limits and red lines, and who checks it before use.	"Return a 5-bullet checklist under 120 words. Do not invent rates, policy requirements, or deadlines. A manager will verify before sending."

Copy-ready starter prompt

Context: You are a [BANKING ROLE] working for [AUDIENCE] in [SITUATION].
Objective: [TASK], so that [GOAL].
Resources: Use only [APPROVED SOURCE]. Use placeholders only.
Expectations: [OUTPUT TYPE], [LENGTH], [ORDER]. Do not invent facts, rates, fees, dates, legal conclusions, or policy requirements.
Mark anything uncertain as [VERIFY]. A qualified human will review before use.

Strip specifics

Replace names, accounts, amounts, dates, addresses, and case facts with placeholders.

Ask for evidence

Tell the AI to separate facts, assumptions, and items requiring verification.

Control the format

Require bullets, tables, checklists, or drafts that a reviewer can scan quickly.

Pick the lane before the prompt

Green - usually safe

No sensitive data and no customer-impacting output. Examples: fictional training scenarios, blank checklists, public-source summaries, role-play prompts, and generic policy-reading aids.

Rule: if it could be written on a break-room whiteboard, it is usually Green.

Yellow - approved tool plus human review

The output could be seen by staff, customers, leadership, or examiners. Examples: campaign copy, policy training, internal procedures, meeting summaries, and customer-facing drafts using placeholders.

Rule: if the output will influence work, a qualified person reviews it before use.

Red - do not use public AI tools

Customer-specific decisions, SAR or AML investigations, adverse-action reasoning, legal conclusions, authentication decisions, confidential exams, vendor contracts, credentials, or production system details.

Rule: if it affects a customer, regulatory filing, control, or credential, treat it as Red until Compliance approves the workflow.

Five safe patterns bankers can reuse

USE WHEN	PROMPT PATTERN	HUMAN CHECK
Rewrite	Rewrite this for [AUDIENCE] in a [TONE] tone. Preserve meaning. Use placeholders only.	Meaning, tone, missing caveats.
Summarize	Summarize this public or approved text into [FORMAT]. Separate facts from assumptions.	Source accuracy and omissions.
Checklist	Turn this procedure into a checklist with owner, evidence, and escalation trigger.	Policy alignment and controls.
Compare	Compare these two redacted options. Return differences, risks, and [VERIFY] items.	Unsupported conclusions.
Train	Create a fictional practice scenario for [ROLE]. No real customers, employees, vendors, or accounts.	Realism without sensitive details.

Verification checklist

- ☐ No customer or employee personal data.
- ☐ No account, loan, card, login, token, or credential details.
- ☐ No invented rates, fees, dates, disclosures, or policy requirements.
- ☐ Facts are tied to an approved source or marked [VERIFY].
- ☐ Customer-facing language has a qualified reviewer.
- ☐ Regulatory, legal, fair-lending, BSA/AML, or security claims are escalated.
- ☐ The output is saved only in an approved system.
- ☐ The final owner is named before anyone acts on it.

Source basis: NIST AI Risk Management Framework, OWASP GenAI Top 10, Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Relationships, CFPB Regulation B, CFPB Regulation P, and FFIEC BSA/AML Manual risk concepts.

Adapt before adopting: This quick card is a training aid, not legal advice or an examiner-approved policy. Adapt it to your institution's approved tools, data classifications, records-retention rules, and review authority.